mind. On reflection, it would, however, appear that all these fundamental tenets are more in the nature of religious beliefs and intuitions rather than the products of Indian reasoning and argument, and that is one reason why they have such a hold on our minds and consciousness. This last characteristic may make them more fundamental, but that certainly does not make them any more philosophical.

If the above reflections are sound, one may well ask how is it that belief in them as the fundamental tenets of Indian philosophy came to be so widely prevalent, both in India and abroad. Well, that is anybody's guess, but, I for one think that it is mainly due to India's contact with the West and is the first fruit of the study of India's religion and philosophy by foreigners. India has always been known to the Western world as a land of a very strange religion, and what was first studied by foreigners was its religious literature; later, these religious beliefs of the Hindus came to be regarded as their philosophical truths. In fact, there was hardly, if ever, any distinction made between India's philosophy and religion. The two were thus confused and identified. The confusion, strange to say, persists even today after more than a century's study of India's philosophy, both by Indians and by foreigners. The time, I believe, has come when students of philosophy all over the world, particularly in India, should think afresh and separate Indian philosophy from Indian religion.